



We built a clearer courtroom record. We would like to show you how.

Who we are

THYLORA is a company that builds a complete simulated world. That world has its own government, its own courts, its own court officers and its own records. We run real courtroom workflows inside it so we can find the places where a record breaks *before* the same break happens in a real courtroom.

We are writing to you as a counterpart. Your office runs a real court. We run a simulated one. The problems are the same: a ruling is spoken, a clerk has to capture it, and every person who reads the record later has to understand it the same way.

How to read this packet

Every item in this packet comes from one of two places, and the frame around it tells you which:

EARTH SOURCE

Black frame, no seal. This material comes from the real world: a real court, a real document or a real person. We quote it. We do not change it.

THYLORA SIMULATION

Red frame, red seal. This material comes from our simulated world. The people named inside a red box are officers of our world, not of any Earth government. The red seal is our world's seal. It is **not** a seal of the State of Maryland or of any Earth government.



Why we write this way

When a word can be read two ways, people pick one. The next person inherits that reading and passes it on. After three handoffs, the office is running on a guess that nobody remembers making. We call this **interpretation drift**.

So we do not aim for *simple*. We aim for **clear and complete**: every time, every date, every person and every "who tells whom" is written out, so the record explains itself and everyone who reads it gets the same meaning the first time.

What we are asking

30 minutes with your courtroom clerks. We will take one real entry from your court, with names removed, and rewrite it with them using the method in this packet. If it does not save time or prevent a single question, you have lost 30 minutes. Contact:

ADD CONTACT

The Earth source we started from

EARTH SOURCE · QUOTED, NOT CHANGED

Document	<i>Courtroom Clerk Feedback for New Judges: What to Do and What Not to Do</i> (3 pages, a survey)
Survey coordinators	Judge CONFIRM NAME Barry and Judge Lisa CONFIRM SPELLING Bobroten
What they did	They coordinated a survey that asked courtroom clerks what new judges should and should not do.
What they did not do	They did not prepare, review or approve this packet. We cite their survey as our starting point. Nothing here speaks for them.

Who prepared this packet

Prepared by	THYLORA, Office of the Chairman
Prepared for	The court office receiving this packet
Date	3 October 2026
What it is	A proposal. It shows a method for writing courtroom records that do not need to be explained. It is not legal advice and it is not a Maryland Rule.

The officers of our world who appear in this packet

THYLORA SIMULATION · OFFICERS OF OUR WORLD



Name	Title in our world	Earth equivalent	What this officer did in this packet
Eddie Riviera	Law Steward CHAIRMAN TO CONFIRM TITLE	Judge	Presided over the simulated proceedings that the examples on pages 3 and 4 come from.
Darius Cole	Keeper of the Record CHAIRMAN TO CONFIRM TITLE	Records custodian	Held custody of the simulated hearing record: who wrote each version, when it changed, and that no version was lost.
Courtroom clerks of our world	Clerk of the Session	Courtroom clerk	Made the clerk observations quoted in this packet. Names listed in the attached roster ADD ROSTER .

Why "Law Steward" and not "Judge": in our world the title means a person who understands the law, keeps learning it, and applies it without prejudice. Their faith, background and life experience are who they are, and they may shape the compassion shown *after* a decision. They do not decide the outcome. The law and the evidence decide it.

One clerk entry, rewritten so it explains itself

The left side shows a typical entry. Each phrase on the left can be read more than one way. The right side shows the same entry with every possible reading closed off.

TYPICAL ENTRY (CAN BE READ MANY WAYS)

~~Recess. Back in 10 minutes. Will update if anything changes. Disposition: per bench.~~

- "Recess": for what purpose? Who called it?
- "Back in 10 minutes": 10 minutes from when? Is the recess 10 minutes long, or does court return after the 10th minute?
- "Will update": who updates, and whom do they tell?
- "Per bench": what exactly was ordered?

CLEAR ENTRY (ONE READING ONLY)

Recess called by	The presiding judge
Purpose	The judge is reviewing the exhibit submitted by defense counsel
Recess began	10:30 AM (clerk reads courtroom clock)
Stated return time	10:40 AM, stated by the judge on the record
If the return time changes	The courtroom clerk announces the new clock time in the courtroom to counsel and to the parties present, and records the new time and the reason
Disposition	Written out in full: sentence, conditions, date, and form numbers

The rule behind it: what the clerk captures, every time

Field	What "clear" means for this field
The ruling	The words of the ruling as spoken, and who spoke them.
Purpose	One concrete reason in plain words ("to review Exhibit 4"). "Purpose" means different things to different people, so the clerk writes the reason itself, not a label.
Times	Clock times (10:40 AM), never durations alone ("10 minutes"). If a duration is spoken, the clerk records both: "10 minutes, return at 10:40 AM".
Who tells whom	Every update names the person giving it and the people receiving it.
Required disposition	Sentence, conditions, effective date and form numbers, each on its own line.

How we teach ambiguity without being ambiguous

We show trainees an unclear entry, ask them to write down what they think it means, and compare their answers. The answers always differ. Then we show the clear version and the single direction we want. The lesson is not "be careful". The lesson is "write it so there is only one way to read it."

PART 3 · THE MEASUREMENTS, WRITTEN THE WAY THEY WOULD APPEAR ON A CLASSROOM BOARD

Each measurement is shown four ways: the expression by itself, a key to every letter, the question the expression asks, and a worked example.

1 · HOW TO MEASURE CHANGE WITHOUT TURNING PEOPLE INTO SCORES

$$\Delta Q = Q_{\text{after}} - Q_{\text{before}}$$

Δ "Delta", the Greek letter for *change*.

Q The quantity measured: one process number, never a person's score. Example: minutes from a spoken ruling to the finished clerk entry.

Q_{before} The average of that number over the 20 court days **before** the new method starts.

Q_{after} The average of the same number, measured the same way, over the 20 court days **after** the new method starts.

THE QUESTION THIS EXPRESSION ASKS

How far did the measured quantity move between the 20 court days before the change and the 20 court days after it?

Example: $\Delta Q = 6 - 14 = -8$. Entries finished 8 minutes faster. For a time measurement, a negative ΔQ means improvement.

2 · IS THE RECORD WORTH RELYING ON?

$$PV = A \times T \times U \times R$$

PV Practical value of one record, from 0 (worthless) to 1 (fully reliable).

A Accurate: matches what was said and ordered (0 to 1).

T Timely: finished within the time the office requires (0 to 1).

U Usable: the next person can act on it without asking (0 to 1).

R Relied on: the people who receive it trust it enough to act on it (0 to 1).

THE QUESTION THIS EXPRESSION ASKS

Is the record accurate, timely, usable and trusted, all at the same time?

Why multiply instead of add: a record that is perfect in three ways and inaccurate in one is not 75% useful. If any factor is 0, PV is 0. Example: $1 \times 1 \times 1 \times 0 = 0$.

3 · WHY THE SAME LETTER Y SOMETIMES CARRIES A T AND SOMETIMES AN X

$$Y_t \text{ and } Y_x$$

Y The outcome being measured, for example entries finished the same day.

t Answers **when**. Y_t is the outcome on day t (Y_1 is day 1, Y_2 is day 2).

x Answers **under which condition**. Y_x is the outcome when condition x is used (x = old entry form, or x = new entry form).

THE QUESTION THIS NOTATION ASKS

Are we comparing the same thing across **time** (t), or across **conditions** (x)? Mixing the two makes it look as if a change caused a result when time alone did.

4 · THE COURT RELATIONSHIP AS ONE MEASUREMENT

$$C = H \times Q \times K$$

C Court quality: how well one handoff in the courtroom works (0 to 1). In our notes, a capital C always means **court**.

H Handoff: the information reached the next person whole (0 to 1).

Q Question quality: the questions asked closed the gaps instead of opening new ones (0 to 1).

K Clarity: the record has exactly one reading (0 to 1).

THE QUESTION THIS EXPRESSION ASKS

When information moves from the bench to the clerk to the next office, does it arrive complete, answered and with only one meaning?

CONFIRM LETTERS This expression was rebuilt from the Chairman's description because the version 3 file was not available. Confirm the letters before printing.

Survey-ready answers: what that means

A **survey-ready answer** is an answer written so that a clerk who takes the same survey could repeat it word for word and the coordinators could count it without interpreting it. Each answer names what was observed, who observed it and when.

Every survey question matters. Earlier versions of this packet featured two questions (numbers 3 and 9). That made those two look like the only ones that counted. They were featured because they concern timing and handoffs, which this packet measures. The full set of questions is answered in the attached sheet **ATTACH SHEET**.

THYLORA SIMULATION · CLERK OBSERVATIONS

Observed by	Clerk of the Session, simulated court of Law Steward Eddie Riviera ADD CLERK NAME
Observed	Punctuality: the time the session was set to start compared with the time it actually started, recorded by clock time on each session day.
Held by	Keeper of the Record Darius Cole, with a full version history



One more idea: decide the facts before seeing the faces

A decision about *what happened* should not depend on who the people are. In our simulated courts we test a two-pass review:

1. **Pass one: facts only.** The reviewer sees "Person 1" and "Person 2". Names, faces, skin color, neighborhood and vehicle are removed. The reviewer decides who acted first and what the evidence shows.
2. **Pass two: context.** Identity and circumstances are restored, for example fear for one's life or why something was taken. Context shapes understanding and compassion. It does not reverse a fact finding made on the evidence.

This idea already exists on Earth. California Penal Code section 741 (from Assembly Bill 2778, signed in 2022) requires prosecutors to do an initial race-blind charging review, starting 1 January 2025. Offices that adopted it reported real costs for redaction software and staff. We would study that cost before recommending the same step anywhere.